

Size matters

I bought a SP0802N Samsung 80 GB 7,200-rpm hard drive, but my PC—a Pentium 4, 1.7 GHZ, 256 MB RAM, 845G chipset motherboard—shows only 76348 MB. Please tell me how I can get the lost capacity of my hard disk back.

Amit Thakur
Via e-mail



ILLUSTRATOR: Mahesh Benkar

Dear Amit,
That difference is where all hard disk manufacturers have made some interesting changes to account for space. Hard disk sizes have so long been specified in Millions of Bytes (1,000 x 1,000) instead of Mega Bytes (1,024 x 1,024), that the computer actually uses it to show hard disk capacity. When disk sizes were measured in Mega Bytes, this difference was negligible, but stepping up to GigaBytes (1,024 x 1,024 x 1,024), multiplies the apparent discrepancy more than a thousand fold.

The 3 GB that you find missing, is mostly that, plus a little overhead in formatting. Some enterprising consumers in the US have recently filed a case against computer and hard disk manufacturers to stop this apparent mis-statement of capacity.

digit

DVD disappointment

Dear Digit,
First of all, thank you for the 10 CD pack. WOW!!! It's really great. I hope you keep sending such goodies to your subscribers.

I don't have a DVD-ROM drive to use the DVD you provided with the August edition of Digit. I have heard that there is a software that will allow me to use the DVD on my CD-ROM drive, but I can't remember its name. Please help my friends and I, so we can use your DVD.

Jawidur Rahman
Via e-mail

Dear Jawaidur,
DVD technology is very different from CD, and uses much higher precision and data density. The DVD we provided carried 4 GB of data, but other DVDs can carry up to four times as much. Just as the CD was a huge leap over floppy disks, this is the next step up from CDs. Don't be deceived by the similarity—just as you can't expect to read a CD in a floppy drive, there is no way to make a CD drive read a DVD disc.

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Digital dissected

Dearest Sumod,

I'm a photographer employed in a photo-lab, and use both digital and analog cameras. I have a point to make, with regards to your digital camera test (September 03).

With all due respect to Mr Sherwin Crasto, and all the charged grey-cells at Digit Test Centre, I do feel the comparison between all the appalling digital cameras could have been more structured (to do justice to their CCDs and their manufacturers). The tests should have been bracketed according to megapixel—for example, comparing 0 to 2 megapixel cameras in separate categories. This way, their performances within their given parameters would have been neither justifiable, nor questionable. Your format, which even photog-

raphy magazines do not follow, will not help most photographers, professionals or amateurs.

I also suggest that you include a regular column with URLs of interesting Web sites, as this will save us the effort of searching and time.

M Narasimha Murthy
Via e-mail

Dear Narasimha,
Most of us have some idea of the amount of money we are prepared to spend for a product, whether a digital camera or a computer. We could just as easily have grouped the digital cameras by one primary feature, instead of by price. But then, what is the question that we answer by giving out an award? For example, we prefer to say "This camera is the best you can buy for under Rs 30,000", rather than saying, "This is the best 3 megapixel camera". Then there is the matter of the key feature being an ambiguous

classifier. Sensor technologies vary considerably across manufacturers, and will continue to diverge for a while, as each company pursues its own research. This means that a 3 megapixel camera from Kodak may not be comparable to a 3 megapixel from Nikon.

You are right about the need for interesting sites, and we do carry them. For your clicking convenience, they are located on the Mindware CD, in the Bookmarks section. Do let us know if you would like us to recommend sites for a topic of your interest.

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More Digital Cameras

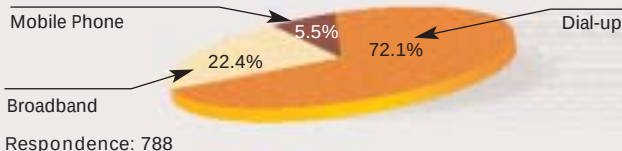
Dear Editor,

I was always confused about picking the right digital camera, but thanks a ton for fixing my problem. Your 31 camera test was very informative, making the September 2003 edition of Digit a really precious one. Now all my confusions have vanished, and I am going to buy a new D-Cam this Diwali, based on your testing. Give yourselves a pat on the back.

Raman Garg
Via e-mail

digit READERPOLLS

Q. What is your primary means of Internet access?



Your vote counts

This month's question:

Question: How satisfied are you with the after-sales service and support you get for your PC and components? Participate in the first annual Digit Service and Reliability Survey to vote for or against your PC vendor. For details turn to Page No. 41

Log on to www.thinkdigit.com and vote